

A course in language creation



Conlangs University

Morphology 1 — Assignment

Morpheme classification & Glossing



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Exercises

Morpheme classification

For each of the following English morphemes, classify them as productive/unproductive and inflectional/derivational.

↓ Morphemes	Unproductive	Productive	Inflectional	Derivational
-ed in helped, constructed, blessed	[]	[]	[]	[]
-t in built, sent, slept	[]	[]	[]	[]
re- in reheat, redo, replay	[]	[]	[]	[]
-fast in steadfast, colorfast, dyefast	[]	[]	[]	[]
-less in wireless, toothless, gormless	[]	[]	[]	[]
-ing in coloring, helping, running	[]	[]	[]	[]

Glossing

Reference material:

- [Leipzig Glossing Rules.](#)
- [List of common glossing abbreviations](#)

Break each of the following English sentences into morphemes and gloss them. Consult the Leipzig Glossing Rules if you have any questions or confusion.

- The cat likes me.
- The children's friends will have told me a story.
- Their story was longer and better.
- The mice aren't walking quickly, they're running slowly.

GHS

The following page(s) will contain the solved assignment, please proceed only if you have completed the assignment yourself and want to check your answers.

Solutions

Morpheme classification

↓ Morphemes	Unproductive	Productive	Inflectional	Derivational
-ed in helped, constructed, blessed		[x]	[x]	
-t in built, sent, slept	[x]		[x]	
re- in reheat, redo, replay		[x]		[x]
-fast in steadfast, colorfast, dyefast	[x]			[x]
-less in wireless, toothless, gormless		[x]		[x]
-ing in coloring, helping, running		[x]	[x]	

Glossing

There's sometimes more than one way to gloss a sentence. These are the ones I've chosen but other abbreviations or stylistic choices are possible.

1.
the cat like-s me
DEF cat like-PRS.3s 1SG.OBJ
2.
the children=s friend-s will have told me a story
DEF child.PL=POSS friend-PL FUT AUX.PFV tell.PTCP 1SG.OBJ a story
3.
their story was long-er and better
3PL.POSS story be.PST long-CMP and good.CMP
4.
the mice are -n't walk-ing quick-ly they ='re run-ning slow-ly
DEF mouse.PL be.PL.PRS-NEG walk-PROG quick-ADV 3PL.NOM=be.PL.PRS run-PROG slow-ADV